Theme 2: Starting University

A Letter to a Teacher (Writing: informal letter)

Lesson 2-5
Book pages 26-27

💡 **Big idea:** A university course co-ordinator welcomes new students and asks them to write a **letter to their English teacher** about themselves. We learn to **make notes**, choose **formal or informal** language, and **proof-read** a partner's work.

🎯 **I will learn:**

- Identify the purpose and style of a letter
- Make notes with key words before writing
- Distinguish formal and informal expressions
- Write a letter to a teacher about yourself

📖 Key words

purpose غرض	**formal** رسمي	**informal** غير رسمي	**proof-read** يراجع ويصحح
draft مسودة	**edit** يحرر ويصحح	**key words** كلمات مفتاحية	

Planning your letter

- Make notes under headings: my family, my spare time activities, learning English, my plans for the future
- Use key words, not complete sentences
- Write a draft, then proof-read and edit

Formal vs informal language

- Formal: Dear..., Yours faithfully, I would be grateful if..., I would like to..., I am writing to...
- Informal: Hi there!, Love from..., 'Bye for now, Have fun!, See ya!
- Neutral: Best wishes, Kind regards

4 **Draw two columns into your exercise book. Write 'Formal language' and 'Informal language' at the top of each column. Write the expressions below into the appropriate column.**

Love from.....	'Bye for now	Hi there!
Dear	Yours faithfully	Kind regards
Have fun!	Best wishes	I am writing to.....
I would be grateful if.....	I would like to.....	See ya!

Formal and informal expressions (p.27)

✏️ Examples

Is 'Yours faithfully' formal or informal?

Answer: formal

Write a note for 'my plans for the future'.

Answer: study engineering – SQU – work in Oman

⭐ Remember

- A letter to a teacher should be friendly but polite: avoid very informal endings like 'See ya!'.

⚠️ Watch out

- ✗ writing full sentences in your notes ✓ use key words only

🧩 **Activity:** Write a letter (150 words) to your new English teacher about yourself, then edit a partner's draft.

✅ Check yourself

1. What is the purpose of the co-ordinator's letter?
2. Formal ending
3. Informal greeting
4. What is a draft?

Answers: (1) all of the above: welcome, give advice, ask students to write ، (2) Yours faithfully ، (3) Hi there! ، (4) writing not in its final form